



THE OPENING OF the two greenfield airports this December—the Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) and the Noida International Airport (NIA)—could be a watershed moment in Indian aviation. They are poised to grant Mumbai and Delhi a transformative twin-airport model, akin to Dubai’s DXB–DWC, London’s Heathrow–Gatwick, and New York’s JFK–Newark, positioning them as a dual-hub ecosystem on the global aviation map.

Also, it’s the first time since 2008 that two greenfield

airports will be operationalised in the same year. The last time was Bengaluru and Hyderabad; the former is also getting ready to welcome a second airport to cater to the growing passenger numbers.

The new airports in the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR) and the National Capital Region (NCR) will also enhance regional connectivity and complement the massive expansion plans of domestic airlines.

“With just 160 airports, India is already the third-largest aviation market. Imagine what will happen if the same growth continues. Aviation is booming in In-